DRAFT for Matt to rewrite in his own words. Every principle below is drawn from how the work on this site was done, with a link to where it shows. Section 6 (how learning works, LIB-37) needs Matt's own beliefs and is left as questions. Marked items: [CONFIRM] = check it's true for you; [YOUR WORDS] = replace with your own.

How I work (LIB-41)

Purpose: one page for a hiring manager or new team on how I scope, govern, build and hand off work, so they know what working with me looks like before the first meeting.

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1. I start with the decision, not the data

Before I build anything, I ask who will act on the answer and what they'll do differently. Then I write down the question and the definitions, and only then the query. Most "the numbers are wrong" problems are two teams answering different questions with the same word.

Where it shows: case study A writes the compliance definition before computing it (metric definitions).

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2. I define, then govern

Every metric that leaves my team has a written definition, an owner, a version number and an as-of date. Definitions change through a stated process, and when they change I show the old number next to the new one for a cycle, with the reason. Data-quality problems get flagged and routed to whoever can fix the source; I don't quietly drop rows to make a number look clean.

Where it shows: the data-quality checklist (LIB-04) and the disputed-KPI process (LIB-50).

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3. I check results, not effort

A report isn't done when the query runs. It's done when I've reproduced the number another way and know why it differs from the last one: reconciling to source, rebuilding it independently, reading records back, tracing a few people end to end. When I test whether something works, I say up front how big an effect the data could detect, so "no difference" doesn't get mistaken for "no effect."

Where it shows: the validation section of every case study; the control backtest in case study D.

4. I build with AI and say so

I write SQL and Python with an AI assistant, and the code on this site is labeled that way. My part is the design, the definitions and the checks. I treat AI output the way I'd treat a new analyst's first draft: useful, fast, and not trusted until it reproduces a known answer.

[CONFIRM] Link to the "How I build with AI" page once it clears review (LIB-28).

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5. I hand off so it runs without me

Work isn't finished until someone else can run it: a README, a reproducible script, a named owner, a schedule, and a list of what to check when it breaks. I'd rather retire a report than maintain one nobody reads.

Where it shows: each case study's Files section; the report rationalization worksheet (LIB-51).

How I communicate

- **Plainly, with the tradeoff.** I'd rather give a direct answer with its limits than a hedged one.
- **Bad news early and in person.** If a number is about to drop because the definition changed, the owner hears it from me first.
- **Fewer priorities, finished.** Three things done beat ten started.

[CONFIRM] These match how you'd describe yourself; add anything colleagues regularly say about working with you. [YOUR WORDS]

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6. How I think learning works (LIB-37)

[YOUR WORDS] Two or three short paragraphs. Questions to answer:

1. What do you believe makes workplace training actually change what people do?
2. What's one common L&D practice you think wastes people's time, and what do you do instead?
3. How does your teaching (adult learners, a community college classroom) shape how you design workplace learning? Keep it general: no course names, materials or students.

Why it’s built this way

[YOUR WORDS] Optional: 3–5 sentences on why you’d put this page in front of a hiring manager.

Format: web page.

Matthew McKay, Ph.D.

Personal project. All data is synthetic or public, and the company is fictional. Views are my own and not affiliated with or endorsed by any current or former employer.